

EDUCATION

- 2021–2027 **Ph.D. in Economics**, *University of California, Berkeley*
(expected) ◦ Fields: Development Economics, Political Economy (Designated Emphasis)
- 2018–2020 **M.Sc. in Economics (2 Year)**, *London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)*
◦ Jointly awarded **Sir John Hicks Prize** for best overall performance
- 2014–2017 **B.A. in International Relations**, *Technische Universität Dresden*, GPA: 4.0 equiv.
◦ Exchange semester at *Université de la Réunion*, France.
◦ Volker-Heinsberg-Award for best bachelor thesis in 2017.

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

Screening for Collusion in Public Procurement: *Evidence from 5 Million Auctions in India*

- Bidder collusion inflates the cost of public procurement, which accounts for close to a third of government spending in developing countries, yet its prevalence remains largely unmeasured where enforcement capacity is weak and prosecutions are rare. Using 42.3 million bids on 15.7 million electronically tendered Indian public contracts since 2008, I build a pair-level screen from twelve warning signals the Competition Commission of India instructs procuring officers to watch for; the flags depend on bidding strategies rather than realized prices. Collusive behavior is diffuse rather than concentrated in a few large cartels – the majority of regular bidders are flagged to collude with at least one partner – and tenders in which a flagged pair wins while its partner also bids settle 3.89 percent higher relative to the government's engineering estimate. A structural estimation recovers markups 3.33 percentage points higher for colluding pairs; competitive pricing would save close to 7.2 percent of the annual procurement budget.

Work in Progress

Pacifying Effects of Minority Political Representation: Evidence from India

- Mandated political representation for low-caste groups in India decreased conflict from insurgency by 5-10% and reduced crime against lower castes.

Hidden Campaign Finance: Evidence from India (with Amol Singh Raswan)

- Firms exploit anonymous donation channels, giving to parties other than those in their publicly disclosed portfolio.

Cognitive Enrichment and Human Capital: Experimental Evidence from Developing Countries (with Uyanga Byambaa)

- Randomized school-based chess programs in Kenya and Malawi raise multiple dimensions of cognitive ability, with larger gains among students who were weaker at baseline.

Publications

"Healthy ageing trends in England between 2002 to 2018 : Improving but slowing and unequal". With Andrew J. Scott. *The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, Vol. 26, 100470. 2023.

"Cycles of Fire: Politics and Forest Burning in Indonesia". With Clare Balboni, Robin Burgess, Anton Heil, and Ben Olken. *AEA Papers & Proceedings* 111: 415-419. 2021.

"Democracy and the transnational dimensions of low-level conflict and state repression". With Martin Rößler and Patrick Zwerschke. *International Studies Quarterly* 65 (3): 753–767. 2021.

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

- Summer 2025 **Summer Associate, Cornerstone Research** (San Francisco)
 - Economic consulting; analysis in support of litigation and regulatory matters
- Fall 2023–2025 **RA for Francesco Trebbi** (UC Berkeley)
 - Work on structural estimation of political economy models
- Summer 2022 **RA for Ted Miguel** (UC Berkeley)
 - Meta-analysis project on climate change and conflict, field project on refugees in Jordan
- 2020–2021 **Predoc for Oriana Bandiera and Robin Burgess** (LSE)
 - Projects in political economy, development/organizational/environmental economics
- 2017–2018 **Intern and RA at ifo Institute for Economic Research** (Dresden)
 - Policy-related economic research on housing prices & immigration, fiscal policy, education

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- CEGA Grant for field work on blood donations in India, 2022 (US\$4,500)
- DAAD Graduate Scholarship for 2018–2020 (€32,000)
- German National Academic Foundation, 2014–2020 (€45,000)

WORKSHOPS AND PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 **Lindau:** Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting on Economic Sciences, Lindau, Germany
- Banff:** Empirical Microeconomics Workshop, Banff, Canada
- 2024 **SASE:** Annual Conference of SASE, Limerick, Ireland
- 2023 **TU Dresden:** German Development Economics Conference
- 2021 **UC Berkeley:** Political Economy Conference, Poster presentation
- 2019 **ISA Toronto:** Annual Convention of International Studies Association
- Uni Münster:** Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship

TEACHING

- 2022–2026 **Graduate Student Instructor, Econ 140 (Econometrics)**, UC Berkeley
 - Outstanding GSI Award for teaching in Fall 2022 and Spring 2023
 - Materials and course evaluations on [my teaching website](#)
- 2018–2024 **Guest Lecturer, Introduction to Interdisciplinary Research** (TU Dresden)

REFEREEING

Econometrica

PERSONAL

- **Languages:** German (native), English, French, Hindi (intermediate)
- **Citizenship:** Germany. US Permanent Resident. Overseas Citizen of India.

REFERENCES

- Edward Miguel, emiguel@berkeley.edu, *University of California, Berkeley*
- Francesco Trebbi, ftrebbi@berkeley.edu, *Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley*
- Frederico Finan, ffinan@berkeley.edu, *University of California, Berkeley*
- Cailin Slattery, cailin.slattery@berkeley.edu, *Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley*